live in a different world." I returned to my office, closed the door, sat down, and began to imagine what the post–September 11 world would look like.

In Judaism, Jews are commanded to engage in soul-searching once a year, on Rosh Hashanah; they are supposed to examine their actions over the year that has passed, both between themselves and their fellow man and between themselves and God. The Jewish New Year and the anniversary of the World Trade Center attacks usually occur in the same month—September. At the International Institute for Counter-Terrorism (ICT) at the Interdisciplinary Center (IDC) Herzliya, which I helped establish and of which I serve as chairman of the board, we decided to hold our annual international conference on the anniversary of the September 11 attacks.

In 2010, the ICT held its ninth international conference. We'd had almost an entire decade since that fateful day to remember, think, analyze, and compare the world that existed before September 11, 2001, and the one that followed it. I myself could testify that the world in 2010 looked worse, much worse, than I had imagined it then, just minutes after watching the disaster unfold on TV. In essence, the most dramatic element of the change was that the post–September 11 world had returned to an era of religious and cultural wars—a world in which Islam was trying to regain the hegemony it had lost, with radical Islam leading the way.

In the aftermath of the attack on the World Trade Center, the world looked to Israel, the Western country with the most experience to date in dealing with terrorism. In retrospect, I must admit that the scope of global radical terrorism was enormous even by our standards.

In the wake of September 11, the US administration underwent a major organizational reform, the largest since the end of World War II. The Department of Homeland Security, which was established following the attacks, is now the largest department in the cabinet. The need to respond to a threat of that scale, while at the same time engaging in fighting, resulted, of course, in a number of mistakes. But, to the Americans' credit, it must be said that they generally detect their mistakes and correct them.

There has been total intelligence and operational cooperation between the United States and Israel in the field of counterterrorism from the get-go. Both sides understood that they had something to learn from each other, as well as the fact that only international cooperation would make it possible to deal with the threat in the most effective way.